

CapEx, OpEx & Open Source

Introduction to the Research Project

at the Linux Foundation Energy OSPO SIG - 2026-05-21



Who we are

- Software engineers
- Open source & inner source strategy, solutions, research
→ caprarodorner.de
- Transfer pricing for collaborative software engineering
→ kolabri.io
- Interdisciplinary focus :-)



Who we are not

- ~~Star Wars Rocker Pirates~~
- ~~Experts in energy regulation~~
- ~~Accountants, bookkeepers~~
- ~~Experts in TSOs', DSOs' daily business~~
- That's why we need your support!
→ More on this in the study design section

Problem Statement

**“We cannot do open source
because we want to recognize
our work as CapEx”**

– Maybe your colleague

Do open source?

USE

A company uses existing open source software as tools to deliver a service or as component of their products.

CONTRIBUTE

A company contributes to existing open source projects, e.g. to make them fitter for use (fix bugs, add features).

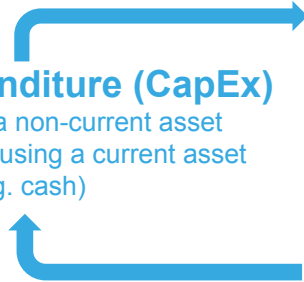
CREATE

A company creates, leads or co-leads open source projects, e.g. to establish market standards or save costs.

CapEx & OpEx

Capital Expenditure (CapEx)

You purchase a non-current asset
(e.g. a machine) using a current asset
(e.g. cash)



Balance Sheet

Assets

Non-current assets

...
...

Current assets

...
...

Liabilities

Non-current liabilities

...
...

Current liabilities

...
...

CapEx & OpEx

Your money is somebody else's current asset now.



Operational Expenditure (OpEx)

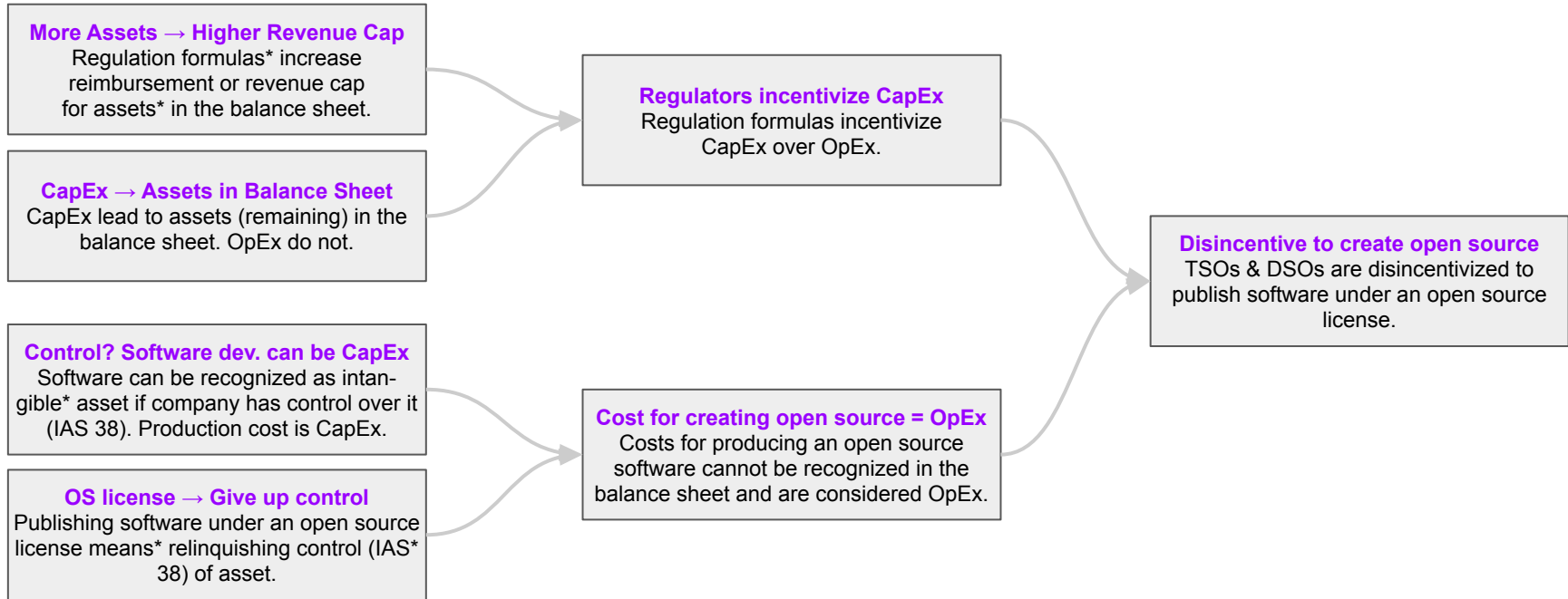
You purchase a service using a current asset. The asset is "gone" from the balance sheet.



Balance Sheet	
Assets	Liabilities
Non-current assets	Non-current liabilities
...	...
...	...
Current assets	Current liabilities
...	...
...	...

Root Cause Analysis

Preliminary! Please consider each element as an assumption



Regulatory incentives favoring CapEx disincentivize creation of open source projects

– More specific problem statement

Study Design

Objectives & Research Questions

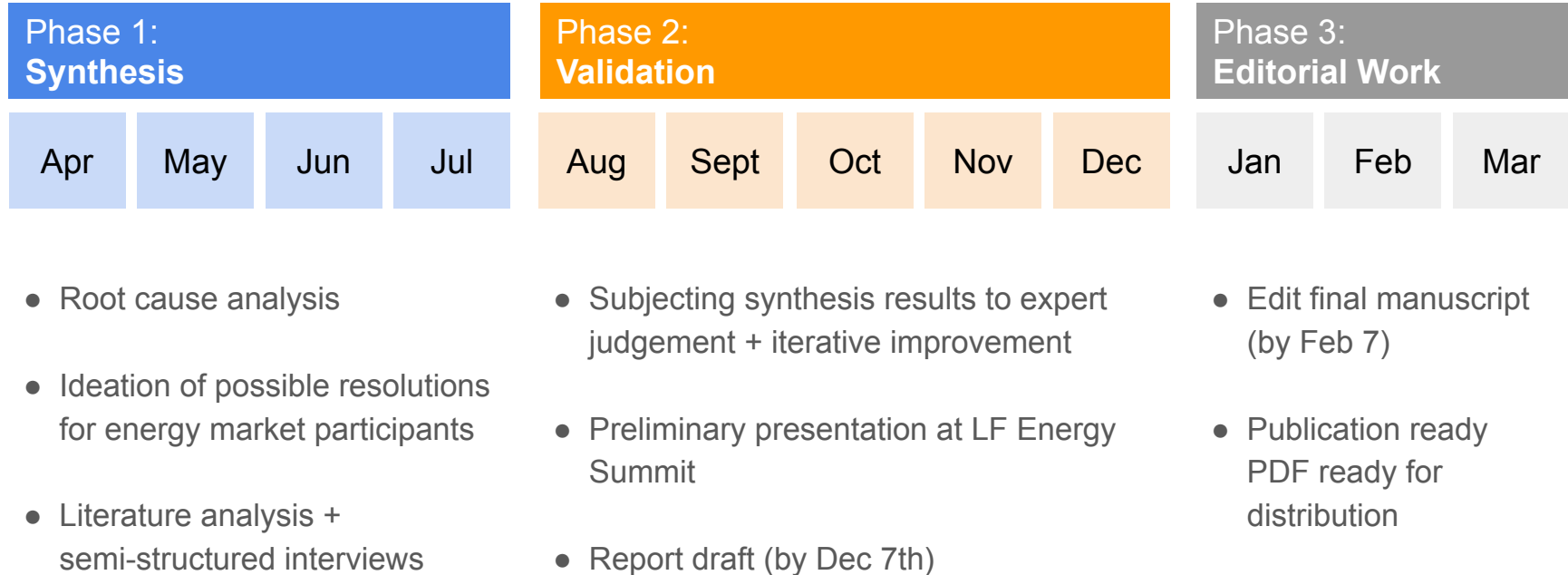
Research Objective

Understanding and mitigating the impact of a disincentive to creating open source projects caused by regulation incentivizing CapEx (“the disincentive”)

Research Questions

1. What are root causes of the disincentive to create open source projects?
2. What is the impact of the disincentive on TSOs, DSOs?
3. How to resolve or mitigate the disincentive / its impact?

Timeline



Your support is more than welcome!

Volunteer for a semi-structured, exploratory interview.

- ±three initial interviews
- Starting mid. June, 60min
- Who? OSPO members
(potentially follow-ups with colleagues)
- 1x interviewee using revenue cap method
- 1x interviewee using cost-based method
- 1x interviewee outside of Europe

Discuss with us and share your perspective today.

- What are your questions, thoughts, concerns?
- How do you experience the CapEx-OpEx-disincentive in your work?
- What are your expectations & wishes towards the study?

Reach out anytime!



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